

Projections 1 - Multiple Choice Questions

1. What is the projection of vector v onto vector u given by?

A. $(u \cdot v)u / \|u\|^2$

B. $(v \cdot u)u$

C. $(u \cdot v)v / \|v\|^2$

D. $(v \cdot v)u / \|u\|^2$

Answer: $(u \cdot v)u / \|u\|^2$

2. If u is a unit vector, how can you simplify the projection formula?

A. $proj_u v = (v \cdot u)u$

B. $proj_u v = (u \cdot u)v$

C. $proj_u v = \|v\| u$

D. $proj_u v = (u \cdot v) v$

Answer: A. $proj_u v = (v \cdot u)u$

3. What geometric relationship holds between $v - proj_u v$ and u ?

A. They are parallel

B. They are perpendicular

C. They have equal magnitude

D. They point in opposite directions

Answer: They are perpendicular

4. If vectors u and v are perpendicular, what is $\text{proj}_u v$?

A. u

B. v

C. 0

D. $u + v$

Answer: 0 (just use the fact that $u \cdot v = 0$ if u and v are perpendicular.)

5. What happens to the projection $\text{proj}_u v$ if v is parallel to u ?

A. It equals v

B. It equals u

C. It equals 0

D. It equals $u - v$

Answer: It equals v

6. Which expression correctly represents the magnitude of the projection $\text{proj}_u v$?

A. $|u \cdot v|$

B. $|v|$

C. $|u \cdot v|/||u||^2$

D. $|u \cdot v|/||u||$

Answer: $|u \cdot v|/||u||$

7. If the angle between u and v is 90 degrees, what is true about their dot product $u \cdot v$?

- A. It equals 1
- B. It equals -1
- C. It equals 0
- D. It equals $\|u\| \|v\|$

Answer: It equals 0

8. When projecting v onto u , the resulting vector will always be:

- A. Longer than v
- B. Shorter than u
- C. Parallel to u
- D. Parallel to v

Answer: Parallel to u

9. Which vector expression correctly gives the component of v perpendicular to u ?

- A. v
- B. $proj_u v$
- C. $v - proj_u v$
- D. $proj_u u$

Answer: $v - proj_u v$

Important note: The midterm and the finals will NOT contain any questions on "Projections 2: on to a hyperplane."